

not the story here. As the *Journal* explained, Netflix used a shotgun approach, spending \$700 million to scoop up a giant netful of Korean films and television shows from 2015 to 2020; the US streaming giant dropped another half a billion dollars on Korea programming in 2021 alone. It was less they saw the appeal of a shocking game with deadly consequences for its contestants than it was sheer luck.

By the time you read this, Season 2 of *Squid Game* will be out.

This is all a reminder of how little we know about the future, and how often sheer randomness determines the outcome of events...



The experts cannot tell what is going to happen with music or movies or television. What about economics and policy? Surely they have *some* insights there?

Surely you jest...

[33](#) Todd Spangler, “‘Squid Game’ Is Decisively Netflix No. 1 Show of All Time With 1.65 Billion Hours Streamed in First Four Weeks, Company Says,” *Variety*(November 16, 2021).

[34](#) Dasl Yoon and Timothy W. Martin, “Netflix’s ‘Squid Game’ Is the Dystopian Hit No One Wanted—Until Everyone Did,” *The Wall Street Journal* (October 4, 2021).